Scale Exercises - Section II, Level 12

Major Scale One-Fret Neck Ladder: A to A

The scale section starts on A.

Play one compact major-scale cell, move the complete frame exactly one fret, and repeat through every major key.

1. Keep the compact shape exact

Root fret R: E string R, R+2; A string R-1, R, R+2; D string R-1, R+1, R+2.
Fingers up: 2-4 | 1-2-4 | 1-3-4.
The four-fret frame runs from R-1 through R+2.

2. Shift one fret after each cell

Begin with **A major at low-E fret 5**. Complete the scale up and down, release pressure, then move the entire hand and thumb one fret higher. Continue to fret 17, reverse, and return one fret at a time.

3. Preserve rhythm and pick cycle

The octave root is played once at the top of the ascent and again to begin the descent, creating an even **16-note cell**. The next key therefore begins with the same pick orientation without a reset.

Worked example - A major at low-E fret 5

Scale notes: A B C# D E F# G# A. The two printed roots at the center are the turnaround.

UP 1-2-3-4-5-6-7-8 | DOWN 8-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------4--6--7--7--6--4-----------------|
A  |------4--5--7-------------------7--5--4--------|
E  |5--7-----------------------------------7--5--|
```

KEY ROUTE A -> Bb -> B -> C -> Db -> D -> Eb -> E -> F -> Gb -> G -> Ab -> A, then reverse.

IMPORTANT Moving one fixed shape by one fret transposes it. A major is the starting rung, not every rung.

A fixed-key A-major position map requires changing the note layout and belongs to a separate later exercise branch.

Session protocol

1. Choose 3-4 neighboring rungs for the first session.
2. Use even eighth notes and repeat the octave root at the turn.
3. Pause one beat after each 16-note cell; move the whole frame one fret.
4. Repeat with a downstroke start and an upstroke start.
5. Remove the pause, connect the rungs, and reverse at fret 17.
6. Add 2 BPM after 3 clean round trips; reduce 4-6 BPM after 2 errors or rising tension.

Level 12 - Chromatic Major-Key Route

Ascending route: complete each scale cell, then move the frame +1 fret

Descending route: use the same cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

Rung	Key	Low-E root	Frame	Scale tones (degrees 1-7)
01	A major	fret 5	4-7	A B C# D E F# G#
02	Bb major	fret 6	5-8	Bb C D Eb F G A
03	B major	fret 7	6-9	B C# D# E F# G# A#
04	C major	fret 8	7-10	C D E F G A B
05	Db major	fret 9	8-11	Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C
06	D major	fret 10	9-12	D E F# G A B C#
07	Eb major	fret 11	10-13	Eb F G Ab Bb C D
08	E major	fret 12	11-14	E F# G# A B C# D#
09	F major	fret 13	12-15	F G A Bb C D E
10	Gb major	fret 14	13-16	Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F
11	G major	fret 15	14-17	G A B C D E F#
12	Ab major	fret 16	15-18	Ab Bb C Db Eb F G
13	A major (octave)	fret 17	16-19	A B C# D E F# G#

How to use the map

Up pass: rungs 01-13.

Turn: complete the high-A cell at fret 17, then reverse direction.

Down pass: rungs 12-01. Do not repeat the high-A card unless you are beginning a new round trip.

Key names: the flat or sharp spelling shown is chosen for readable scale notation. The physical fret is unchanged by enharmonic naming.

Goal: hear the same major-scale interval formula while the root rises and falls chromatically.

Mastery gate before the next scale level

Name every key before playing it; keep the frame compact; land the new root without sliding; preserve equal note length and volume; complete the full fret-5 to fret-17 to fret-5 route with both pick starts; and recover the correct key immediately after any deliberate random stop.

Level 12 - Major Scale One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rungs 01-04: play each card as one cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

01 A MAJOR

ROOT E5 | FRAME 4-7

Notes: A B C# D E F# G# A

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------4--6--7--7--6--4-----------------|
A  |------4--5--7-------------------7--5--4--------|
E  |5--7-----------------------------------7--5--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

02 BB MAJOR

ROOT E6 | FRAME 5-8

Notes: Bb C D Eb F G A Bb

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------5--7--8--8--7--5-----------------|
A  |------5--6--8-------------------8--6--5--------|
E  |6--8-----------------------------------8--6--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

03 B MAJOR

ROOT E7 | FRAME 6-9

Notes: B C# D# E F# G# A# B

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------6--8--9--9--8--6-----------------|
A  |------6--7--9-------------------9--7--6--------|
E  |7--9-----------------------------------9--7--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

04 C MAJOR

ROOT E8 | FRAME 7-10

Notes: C D E F G A B C

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------7--9--10-10-9--7-----------------|
A  |------7--8--10------------------10-8--7--------|
E  |8--10----------------------------------10-8--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Level 12 - Major Scale One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rungs 05-08: play each card as one cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

05 DB MAJOR

ROOT E9 | FRAME 8-11

Notes: Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------8--10-11-11-10-8-----------------|
A  |------8--9--11-------------------11-9--8--------|
E  |9--11-----------------------------------11-9--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

06 D MAJOR

ROOT E10 | FRAME 9-12

Notes: D E F# G A B C# D

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------9--11-12-12-11-9-----------------|
A  |------9--10-12-------------------12-10-9--------|
E  |10-12-----------------------------------12-10-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

07 EB MAJOR

ROOT E11 | FRAME 10-13

Notes: Eb F G Ab Bb C D Eb

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------10-12-13-13-12-10----------------|
A  |------10-11-13-------------------13-11-10-------|
E  |11-13-----------------------------------13-11-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

08 E MAJOR

ROOT E12 | FRAME 11-14

Notes: E F# G# A B C# D# E

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------11-13-14-14-13-11----------------|
A  |------11-12-14-------------------14-12-11-------|
E  |12-14-----------------------------------14-12-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Level 12 - Major Scale One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rungs 09-12: play each card as one cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

09 F MAJOR

ROOT E13 | FRAME 12-15

Notes: F G A Bb C D E F

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------12-14-15-15-14-12----------------|
A  |------12-13-15-------------------15-13-12-------|
E  |13-15-----------------------------------15-13-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

10 GB MAJOR

ROOT E14 | FRAME 13-16

Notes: Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F Gb

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------13-15-16-16-15-13----------------|
A  |------13-14-16-------------------16-14-13-------|
E  |14-16-----------------------------------16-14-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

11 G MAJOR

ROOT E15 | FRAME 14-17

Notes: G A B C D E F# G

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------14-16-17-17-16-14----------------|
A  |------14-15-17-------------------17-15-14-------|
E  |15-17-----------------------------------17-15-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

12 AB MAJOR

ROOT E16 | FRAME 15-18

Notes: Ab Bb C Db Eb F G Ab

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------15-17-18-18-17-15----------------|
A  |------15-16-18-------------------18-16-15-------|
E  |16-18-----------------------------------18-16-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Level 12 - Major Scale One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rung 13 and full-ladder consolidation

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

13 A MAJOR (OCTAVE)

ROOT E17 | FRAME 16-19

Notes: A B C# D E F# G# A

16-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--4--5--6--7--8--8--7--6--5--4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--2--4--1--3--4--4--3--1--4--2--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------------------|
D  |---------------16-18-19-19-18-16----------------|
A  |------16-17-19-------------------19-17-16-------|
E  |17-19-----------------------------------19-17-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Full round-trip challenge

1. Start at A major, fret 5.
2. Play all 13 cells without restarting the pick cycle.
3. Reverse at fret 17 and return through rungs 12-01.
4. Say each key name aloud before its root note.
5. Repeat with the opposite starting stroke.

Clean-round standard: no open strings, no dragged shift noise, no missing accidental, and no tempo change at the one-fret relocations.

After the basic ladder is clean

Accent rotation: accent degrees 1, then 3, then 5, then 7 without changing the fingering.

Rhythm: eighth notes, straight sixteenths, then four-note bursts with one beat of rest between keys.

Direction: begin some sessions at fret 17 and descend first.

Random entry: choose any root fret from 5-17, name the key, play its cell, then continue in either direction.

Practice log

Date	BPM	Start stroke	Clean route?	Notes

Advance after two separate clean days, not one unusually good run.